

Language & Context = Intention + Function
Cue and clues in GP Paper 2: Skills for SAQ & Summary

Passages in Paper 2 are not a wall of faceless words. It is carefully edited and worded by examiners who want to share alternative ideas about an issue with you. There is a context to an issue discussed. The text is structured by typical features such as paragraphing, linguistic devices & punctuation. It is possible to do well in comprehension without having to understand every word or phrase or tackle every question in the QP.

Context is everything

Exam Technique 1: Scanning and Skimming

Understand that context **shapes and determines** the quality of your answer: Use precis /source, lines refereed in SQA , summary and AQ questions as clues to 'break quickly into' the subject matter discussed in the passage, even before you read the it whole.

Track and Highlight: Main and supporting reasons (useful for summary and AQ later esp under exam conditions?). Note the **types of examples or assertions** used by author (possible area of critique for AQ?). P2 is no Gospel.

Textual Form and Linguistic Devices: Like hitchhikers, writers use discourse markers to signpost their opinions, direct and argue their points. Highlight them. Paragraphs are there for a reason too! **Annotate wisely**. Don't wait till the AQ to do so! Your blood will boil and sweat will collect on your brow by then. It's needless!

Exam Technique 2: Check question types and marks allocated to an answer

Skills Tested	QUESTION TYPE & CLUES to Note	To answer well, think and present answers in the following manner-
❖ Rephrasing/ Paraphrasing without losing original meaning intended!	<i>What, UYOW...</i>	Use synonyms, antonyms, different parts of speech, check suitability and accuracy by referring to source and context again!
❖ Identification	<i>Identify, Which, Name the ...List...</i>	Ok to lift but structure points clearly.
❖ Inference and Explanation	<i>Explain, why does, illustrate, describe, what is...implied by...</i> <i>Explain difference / distinctions between...</i>	He means that...This is to show that... It indicates that... A is.....while B is..... The author does this to show that.....
❖ Understanding function & effect of literary devices, figurative language, punctuation etc. <i>Irony is the difference between initial expectation and actual outcome. Your answer must show how it differs from an earlier expectation.</i>	<i>What can we know about the author's tone when he says.....</i> <i>What does this word reveal about her...(Feelings OR Attitude)</i> <i>Use a word that suggests his emotion. (Feelings)</i> <i>What is author's opinion on the issue? (Attitude)</i> <i>Explain what author means by using "simile/ metaphor / irony / paradox"</i>	• Tone (how it sounds): how something is said e.g. <i>sarcastic</i> • Feelings (what the emotion feels like e.g. <i>hurt</i> • Attitude (what is the author thinking about /intention?): what is he like e.g. detached Give literal meaning followed by contextual meaning. Irony: <i>Usually one would...However in this case...</i> Paradox: <i>One is expected to...However...</i>

	Why does the writer use...	Technical use vs contextual use / effect
	Exclamation mark (!) Quotations & inverted commas ("...") Parenthesis / brackets (.....) Dots / ellipsis (...) colon (:) semi-colon (;)...	(!) Explosive reaction / shock / often refers to main point in paragraph. (".....") Means to possibly suggest the opposite / disagreement / wrong choice / word doesn't exist! Casting doubt on something. () Aside, additional or personal comments / opinions provided. Slips in his own thoughts about an issue. (...) Dramatic pause, omission, suspense, more to come, a long list or cycle, unknown effects (:) to list or enumerate- <i>The following are Axis powers: Germany, Italy and Japan.</i> (;) to show contrast- <i>To err is human: to forgive, divine.</i> (;) to show related terms or characteristics- <i>Reading maketh a full man; conference, a ready man; writing, an exact man.</i>

More on attitude-

Features in author's writing	Possible attitude
listing problems and criticisms	Critical / disapproving
Same as above but include words that are worded negatively...negative emotions	Disgust / disdain
Tone is less critical but more open, probing or questioning. Highlights issues in a reflective way.	Doubt / skeptical / skepticism / intellectual curiosity, careful critique
Issues warning, forewarns , list problems to be avoided	Cautious, cautionary, qualified concern, expertise and authority

Refer to additional notes (to come) on the use of other rhetorical devices e.g. irony & voice in writing

Parting Advice, for now

Always refer to the text to determine the accuracy of your answer. Like an essay, examine how and why writers make different paragraphs work together to convey key arguments. The surrounding words (before and after a line!) are important as well. You create the same impact each time you deal with Paper 1. Never forget the 'big idea' author is driving at behind the perceived wall of words. And she / he isn't perfect, just like you and me. **That's the fun in AQ, in time to come ☺**

Reinforce your learning by examining past compre. passages and answer schemes.
Be careful of dodgy versions (written by undergrads!) given by several scheming tuition agencies!

